

CRM

UI/UX Product Standard

Domain Standard #03 · Modern Customer Relationship Management

Design direction: Modern Revenue Workspace · Relationship-first · Contextual · Intelligent · Fast

Purpose: Establish a reusable CRM UI/UX standard for managing customer relationships, leads, opportunities, conversations, activities and revenue workflows.

Modernity rule: The CRM should feel like a contemporary revenue workspace—not a legacy contact database with forms and tables.

1. CRM Product Definition

A CRM centralizes customer and prospect information while helping teams acquire, qualify, engage, convert and retain relationships. Its UX must connect people, interactions, activities and commercial outcomes in one continuous context.

Core UX objective: help users understand the customer context and take the next best action with minimal friction.

Primary CRM user groups

- **Sales:** leads, opportunities, pipeline, activities and closing.
- **Customer success:** accounts, health, renewals, onboarding and issues.
- **Marketing:** segments, campaigns, attribution and engagement.
- **Managers:** pipeline visibility, forecasting, workload and team performance.
- **Admins:** data governance, automation, permissions, integrations and configuration.

2. Modern CRM Design Language

Style type: Modern Revenue OS / Relationship Workspace

- **Visual tone:** premium, energetic, focused and trustworthy.
- **Layout:** flexible workspace combining lists, pipelines, timelines, metrics and contextual detail.
- **Density:** medium information density with strong hierarchy and progressive disclosure.
- **Surfaces:** restrained cards, subtle borders, clear grouping and lightweight elevation.
- **Navigation:** persistent primary navigation with fast access to records and workflows.
- **Interaction:** command search, quick actions, inline updates, drag-and-drop pipelines and contextual actions.
- **Intelligence:** surface relationship signals, recommendations and anomalies without obscuring source data.

3. Current CRM UI Pattern Expectations

The CRM baseline should use modern patterns when they reduce cognitive load or accelerate relationship workflows.

Pattern	CRM expectation	Example
Global search	Search people, companies, deals and activities from one entry point.	Type a customer name and jump directly to the account.
Command actions	Provide fast actions for frequent operations.	Create lead, log call, schedule meeting or send message.
Pipeline board	Use visual stages for opportunity progression.	Drag a deal from Qualified to Proposal.
Record workspace	Combine identity, context, activity and actions.	Account header + contacts + timeline + open opportunities.
Activity timeline	Create one chronological relationship history.	Call → email → meeting → note → proposal.
Next-best action	Surface useful suggested actions based on context.	Follow up on an opportunity with no activity for 7 days.
Saved views	Support role-specific recurring work queues.	My Leads, Closing This Month, At-Risk Accounts.
AI assistance	Summarize and prioritize without replacing user judgment.	Account summary generated from recent interactions.
Inline editing	Allow safe changes without navigating away.	Update lead status or owner directly in a list.

Pattern	CRM expectation	Example
Omnichannel context	Unify relevant communication touchpoints.	Email, call, meeting and chat activity in one timeline.

4. CRM Information Architecture

Organize around the relationship lifecycle rather than only database entities.

- **Home / Workspace:** personalized tasks, pipeline, alerts, priorities and activity.
- **Leads:** capture, qualification, assignment and nurturing.
- **Accounts:** organizations, customer profile, contacts and relationship health.
- **Contacts:** people, roles, communication history and preferences.
- **Opportunities:** pipeline, stages, value, probability, activities and forecasts.
- **Activities:** calls, emails, meetings, tasks and follow-ups.
- **Campaigns:** audience, engagement, attribution and conversion.
- **Reports & Analytics:** funnel, pipeline, activity, retention and revenue views.
- **Automation:** workflows, rules, triggers and integrations.
- **Administration:** roles, permissions, fields, lifecycle rules and data governance.

5. CRM Navigation Standard

Recommended model: Global navigation → Workspace → Record → Context → Action.

- Make search and quick-create actions globally accessible.
- Keep frequently used records and saved views one click away.
- Persist active filters, view mode and relevant context.
- Use contextual navigation between related records: Account → Contact → Opportunity → Activity.
- Keep global utilities consistent across the product.
- Support keyboard shortcuts for expert users where appropriate.

6. CRM Design System Foundations

Foundation	CRM standard
Grid	12-column desktop grid; flexible split workspace for list/detail layouts.
Spacing	4px base; primary rhythm 8/12/16/24/32px.
Typography	Modern sans-serif; 14px body, 12px supporting, 20–32px hierarchy.
Radius	6–10px for controls and surfaces; reserve pills for tags/statuses.
Color	Neutral foundation + brand accent + semantic lifecycle/status colors.
Density	Comfortable default with optional compact expert mode.
Motion	Short functional transitions for stage changes, panels and feedback.
Iconography	Consistent family with explicit semantic meaning.

7. Customer Record Experience

The customer record is the CRM's central information object. It should provide a complete relationship picture without forcing users to open multiple screens.

- **Identity header:** customer/company name, type, owner, status and primary actions.
- **Summary:** key attributes, value, lifecycle stage and health signals.
- **Relationship:** contacts, teams, linked organizations and opportunities.
- **Timeline:** chronological interactions and meaningful system events.
- **Commercial context:** opportunities, orders, subscriptions or revenue where relevant.
- **Tasks:** outstanding follow-ups and scheduled activities.
- **Notes/files:** relevant knowledge and attachments.
- Keep the most decision-relevant information visible; move secondary attributes into expandable sections.

8. Pipeline & Opportunity UX

- Represent stages visually and consistently across pipeline views.
- Show deal value, owner, expected close date, age and risk indicators.
- Support drag-and-drop only when stage transitions are safe and permission-aware.
- Use stage-specific required fields where business logic requires them.
- Provide a detail drawer or split workspace for quick inspection.
- Make stale opportunities and missing next actions visible.
- Forecast views should distinguish actual, committed and projected values clearly.

9. Lead Management UX

- Optimize lead capture for speed and data quality.
- Show source, owner, score, lifecycle stage and last activity in the primary list.
- Use qualification workflows that progressively collect information rather than presenting a massive form.
- Make duplicate detection visible before creating another customer record.
- Allow conversion from lead to account/contact/opportunity without losing activity history.
- Use clear ownership and follow-up states.

10. Activity & Communication UX

- Provide a unified activity timeline for calls, meetings, emails, tasks and notes.
- Allow quick logging from the current record context.
- Use contextual compose actions: email, call, schedule meeting or create task.
- Show upcoming commitments separately from historical activity.
- Make overdue activities visually prominent but not alarmist.
- Preserve communication metadata and timestamps.
- Use concise system language that tells the user what happened and what to do next.

11. AI & Intelligent CRM Standard

AI should reduce repetitive CRM work while preserving user control over customer-facing and revenue-impacting decisions.

- Use AI for account summaries, call summaries, lead classification, email drafting, follow-up suggestions and opportunity risk signals.
- Label AI-generated content clearly.
- Allow users to review, edit and approve generated content before sending or committing consequential changes.
- Provide supporting context when an AI recommendation influences prioritization.
- Never silently overwrite authoritative CRM data with generated content.
- Provide feedback/correction mechanisms to improve the system.

12. Dashboard & Revenue Workspace

- Personalize dashboards by role: salesperson, manager, customer success or executive.
- Prioritize actions and exceptions over decorative metrics.
- Use funnel and pipeline visualization when it supports decision-making.
- Allow drill-down from KPI → segment → record.
- Surface tasks, upcoming meetings, stale deals and follow-ups alongside performance.
- Support saved dashboards/views for different working modes.

13. Forms & Data Quality

- Use progressive disclosure for advanced customer attributes.
- Validate emails, phone numbers and identifiers appropriately.
- Use controlled vocabularies for lifecycle, lead source and status.
- Detect duplicates before creation or conversion.
- Distinguish user-entered data from system-derived fields.
- Preserve unsaved work during validation failures.
- Make required fields explicit and explain why information is required when the reason is not obvious.

14. Example — Sales CRM Flow

- **Lead list:** source, lead, score, owner, stage, last activity and next action.
- **Qualification:** capture only information required to decide whether to progress.
- **Conversion:** create/link account and contact, then open an opportunity where relevant.
- **Opportunity:** pipeline stage, value, expected close, activities, contacts and risk.
- **Follow-up:** create next task or meeting directly from the opportunity.
- **Close:** record outcome and preserve the full relationship history.

15. Example — Customer Success Workspace

- Start with account health, renewal date, value and open risks.
- Show customer contacts and recent interactions.
- Surface unresolved tasks, support issues and product engagement.
- Highlight renewal risk with explainable signals rather than unexplained scores.
- Provide a clear next-action area for the success manager.

16. Accessibility & Inclusive UX

- Target WCAG 2.2 AA for core workflows.
- Support keyboard navigation, visible focus and logical tab order.
- Do not use color as the only indicator for lead, deal or account state.
- Provide accessible names for icon-only actions.
- Ensure timeline, pipeline and drag interactions have keyboard-accessible alternatives.
- Maintain adequate contrast and readable type at normal zoom levels.

17. Responsive Strategy

- **Desktop:** full CRM workspace with pipeline, lists, split views and dashboards.
- **Tablet:** prioritized account, opportunity and activity workflows.
- **Mobile:** quick actions, calls, notes, tasks, customer lookup and urgent updates.
- Transform pipelines and tables into focused cards or lists rather than shrinking desktop layouts.
- Preserve customer context when moving between mobile actions.

18. CRM UX Quality Gates

Gate	Validation question
Relationship clarity	Can the user understand the customer context without hunting across screens?
Next action	Is the next meaningful action obvious?
Speed	Can frequent activities be logged or updated quickly?
Data quality	Does the UX reduce duplicates and incomplete records?
Pipeline clarity	Can users understand stage, value, ownership and risk?
Intelligence trust	Can users distinguish AI suggestions from verified data?

Gate	Validation question
Scalability	Does the design work across large account and activity datasets?
Accessibility	Can core CRM workflows be completed without pointer-only interaction?
Modernity	Do current patterns improve the workflow without adding trend-driven noise?

19. Design-Glanza Product Builder Rules

- Generate the CRM design system before generating CRM modules.
- Treat Account, Contact, Lead, Opportunity and Activity as reusable core objects.
- Generate list, board, split-view, detail, timeline and dashboard patterns as needed.
- Use current SaaS patterns—command search, saved views, contextual actions, side panels, inline editing and progressive disclosure.
- Generate realistic states: new, active, stale, overdue, qualified, unqualified, won, lost, archived and permission-restricted.
- Add AI capabilities only where they improve a concrete CRM task.
- Maintain a single interaction language across sales, marketing and customer-success workflows.
- Audit the product for data quality, accessibility, consistency, responsive behavior and workflow efficiency.

20. CRM Standard Summary

Style: Modern Revenue OS / Relationship Workspace

UX model: Discover → Understand → Prioritize → Act → Follow up → Learn

Visual priority: customer context → next action → relationship history → commercial outcome

Modern patterns: command search, pipeline boards, record workspaces, activity timelines, saved views, contextual actions and responsible AI assistance

Non-negotiables: customer context, speed, data quality, permission accuracy, accessibility and trust.

Domain Standard #03 for the Design-Glanza domain library. Product research, brand systems and business rules may extend this baseline, but deviations should be intentional and documented.